

the 2000s.

The 1990s had the lowest failure rates and the 2010s had the highest, showing an increasing trend to fail.

[**Table 69.9**](#) shows how busted patterns perform.

Busted patterns count. A lot of patterns bust, and the V-bottom is no exception. Over a quarter of them will see price rise less than 10% after the breakout, head down, and close below the bottom of the pattern, busting the upward breakout.

Busted occurrence. A single busted pattern would send price lower after an upward breakout. Indeed, we see most of the busts are single ones. That's especially true in bear markets where 90% of the patterns that bust are single busts. For a double or triple+ (more than two) bust, price has to cross from the bottom of the pattern to above the top. That's a long hike, so double and triple+ busts are rare.

Busted and non-busted performance. Because we're dealing with a pattern that has an upward breakout, a busted pattern would send price lower. That's why you see negatives in the table. It measures the drop from the bottom of the pattern to the ultimate low. Single busted patterns outperform the single, double, and triple+ busts (all busted patterns), as one might expect. I also include the drop from a V-top, which is the closest pattern to a V-bottom except it has a downward breakout. The results compare busted patterns with a normal drop from a V-top.

[**Table 69.9**](#) Busted Patterns

Description	Bull Market	Bear Market
Busted patterns count	592 or 30%	435 or 26%
Single bust count	440 or 74%	392 or 90%
Double bust count	130 or 22%	35 or 8%
Triple+ bust count	22 or 4%	8 or 2%
Performance for all busted patterns	-18%	-22%
Single busted performance	-22%	-24%
Non-busted performance (V-tops)	-15%	-24%